

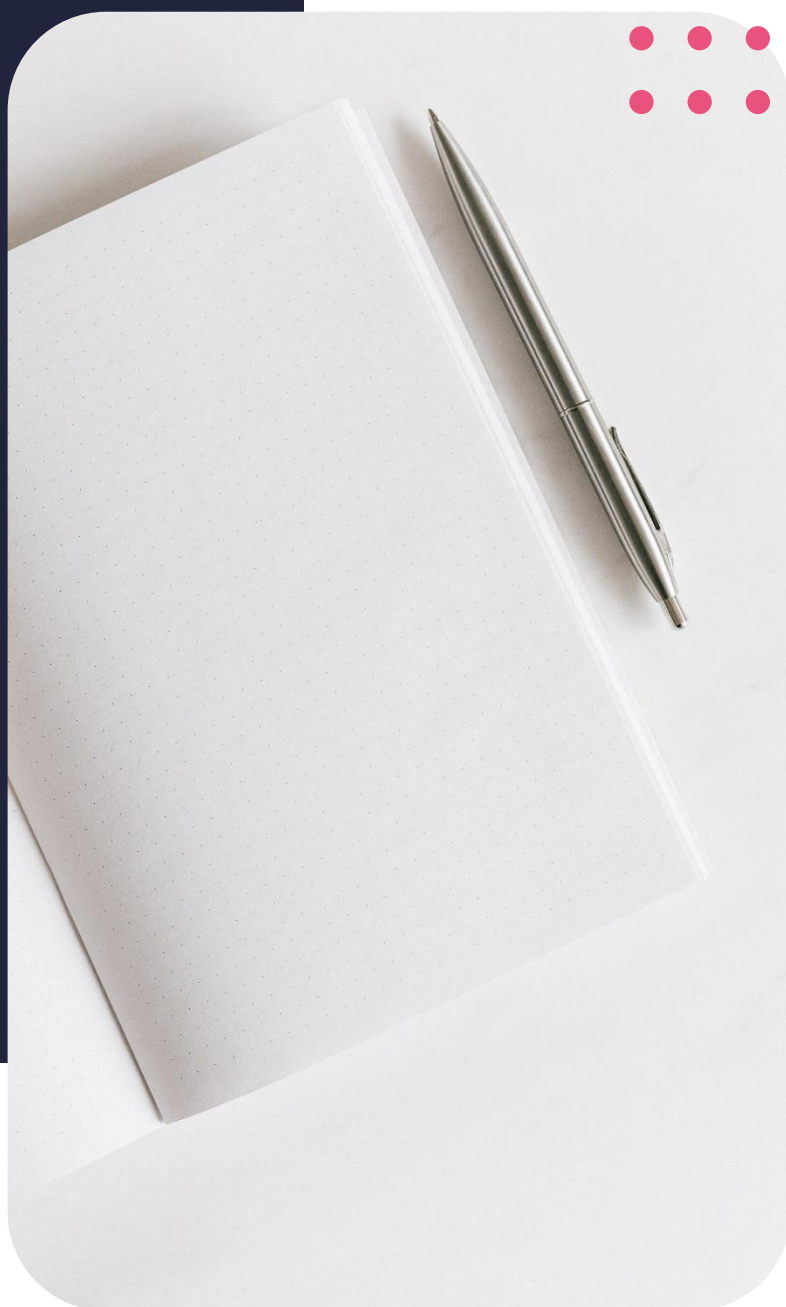
Diploma in Leadership & Management

Leaders Empower Innovation and Creativity



Contents

3	Lesson 8 Objectives
	Introduction
	Key Reading Materials
	Assessment to take
4	Components of creativity
5	Qualities of creative people
6	Types of creativity
7	How to think more creatively
8	Fun ways to improve your creative thinking
10	Bibliography



Lesson 8 Objectives

- How leaders foster innovation
- How leaders promote creativity
- How leaders promote knowledge sharing and collaboration

Lesson Introduction

Innovation and creativity are the building blocks needed to create growth in the business world. Innovation and creativity lead to new and better products, new markets and so much more. It pushes people to think outside of the box and reach new heights.

Arthur C. Clarke said: "The only way to discover the limits of the possible is to go beyond them into the impossible".

Key Reading Materials

- <https://www.onedesk.com/innovation-in-the-workplace/>
- <https://www.siliconrepublic.com/advice/innovation-workplace-cheryl-cran>
- <https://managementhelp.org/innovation/index.htm>
- <https://www.braineet.com/blog/encouraging-workplace-innovation/>

Self-Assessment: Company Culture

How creative are you?: <https://www.psychologies.co.uk/test-whats-your-creative-style>

According to (Bhasin, 2019), we will see the types of creativity, elements of creativity and the qualities of creative people.

Components of creativity

Top Creative Thinking Skills

ANALYTICAL

Ability to analyze things first

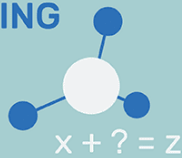


OPEN-MINDED

Thinking of things no one else has considered before

PROBLEM SOLVING

Ability to solve an important issue



ORGANIZATION

Being able to structure a plan of action with clear goals and deadlines



COMMUNICATION

Strong written and oral skills, ability to listen and ask the right questions



the balance

Originality

"The method or idea must be new and unique. It should not be the extension of something which already exists. However, one can take inspiration from the already existing methods and ideas to fabricate something new and unique".

Functionality

The idea of creative approach must also be practical. If the idea does not add value, there is no point in creating it.

Qualities of creative people



Energetic

Creative people tend to have a lot of physical and mental energy. They use this energy to focus on a problem or idea to be more creative. Creative people tend to spend a lot of time alone to really think and express themselves.

They are smart

Truly creative people are very smart and great problem solvers. Their IQ plays a big role in how they approach creativity. This does not mean that you cannot be creative if you don't have a high IQ. It just means that you have to work or practice more as we said with a growth mindset.

Disciplined

People who are creative have the discipline or growth to make sure they push themselves to solve the problem and be creative. They do not stop until they reach their goal.

Types of creativity



Deliberate and cognitive creativity

“People who fall under this type of category of creativity are usually proficient at research, problem- solving, investigation and experimentation. This type of creativity is in the brain’s prefrontal cortex, which is at the front part of the brain. These types of creative people spend a great deal of time every single day testing to develop new solutions”.

These types of people are very purposeful. They have a very good amount of knowledge about a specific topic. They use their skills and knowledge to be creative.

Deliberate and emotional creativity

“People who are categorized as deliberate and emotional let their work be influenced by their state of emotions. These types of creative people are very emotional and sensitive in nature. These individuals prefer relatively quiet and personal time to reflect and they usually have a habit of diary writing. However, they are equally logical and rational in decision making”.

Their creativity comes from having a balance between emotional thinking and using logical actions to implement emotional thinking.

Spontaneous and cognitive creativity

Isaac Newton is an example of this type of creativity. He got the idea about the law of gravity when an apple hit his head while he was sitting under a tree and relaxing. “This is the ‘Eureka!’ moments for Newton and an excellent example of a spontaneous and cognitive person”.

This type of creativity is when you have a lot of knowledge about a subject or topic but you need a bit of inspiration to be creative.

Spontaneous and Emotional Creativity

“Spontaneous and emotional creativity takes place in the “amygdala” part of the human brain. Amygdala is responsible for all emotional types of thinking in the human brain. Spontaneous ideas and creativity happen when the conscious and prefrontal brain is resting. This type of creativity is mostly found in a great artist such as musicians, painters, and writers etc. This type of creativity is also related to ‘epiphanies’”.

This creativity allows for an enlightened person to look at a problem and come up with a ‘deep’ solution. This type of creativity is like a talent, it’s very hard to develop and will take a lot of time and practice.

How to think more creatively



According to (Sicinski, 2019), the following actions will help to develop creative thinking.

Ask more questions

Try to understand the problem or objective more when you get started. This will allow you to better understand what the needs are for change and how you can come up for a better solution. Ask yourself questions about what you would like about the objective and what you want out of it. You can ask more questions to those around you to get more ideas.

Play with ideas

Take time to come up with different ideas and start playing with the practicality of all the ideas. This will help you start to eliminate some of the ideas that don't work.

Test and experiment

Once you have some great ideas down that you think can work. Start building your prototype and test your idea. Does it work like you thought it would? Is something missing? What do others think?

You can test more than one idea and ask for feedback to improve what you have.

Keep an open mind

Try not to get focused on one idea and when it does not work, you want to give up. Be open to changes from your original idea and allow for an organic process to happen. You can design the idea, test it and allow for changes.

Break the rules

You can push your idea as far as you want. There is no rule book when it comes to what you can achieve. Make sure that you're following your gut and trying your idea. Have the confidence to push for your idea.

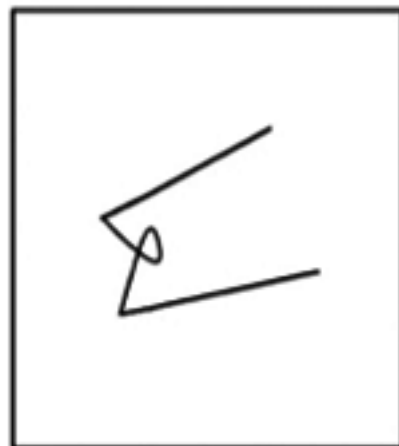
Fun ways to improve your creative thinking



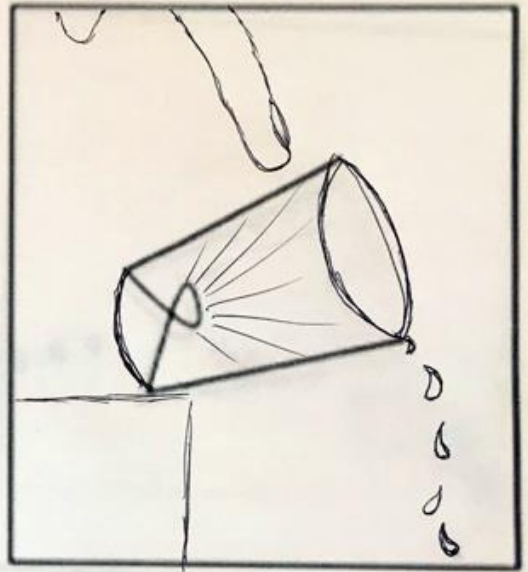
According to (Artwork, 2018), there are several ways you can quickly improve your creative thinking.

Complete an incomplete figure test

For example, people were giving the following picture to complete.

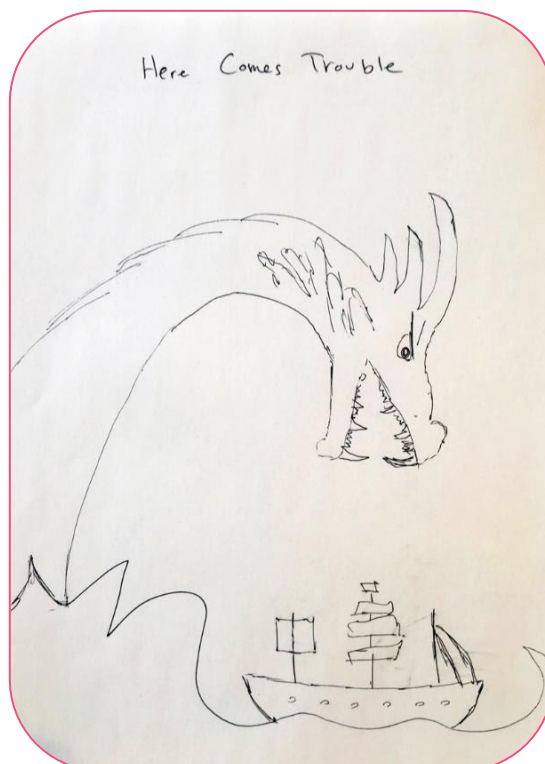


People then came up with the following:



Complete the picture

People are giving phrases that they have to use to be more creative. You can use the phrase to either write a short few sentences or to draw a picture. For example: "Here comes trouble".



Think tank

Use a think tank system where you allow people at work to be creative.

You can have small meetings with a few people where you tackle common issues in the workplace. Come up with creative/innovative ideas that can solve the issues. Come up with strategies that you can bring to management to solve the issues.

Give yourself free time

Go for a run or do something physical and clear your mind. Think of times in the day where you can take a bit of time for yourself. This will help you be more creative at work as you can refocus and get rid of some stress.

Go for quantity over quality

Just go for it. Try to think of as many ideas as you can. It does not matter how good or bad the idea is. This will help you review the ideas and you can start to see a pattern or idea that you can build off of.

Bibliography

Artwork. (2018, Sept 9). *7 Fun Exercises to Quickly Improve Creative Thinking*. Retrieved from Artwork Archive: <https://www.artworkarchive.com/blog/7-fun-exercises-to-quickly-improve-creative-thinking>

Bhasin, H. (2019, Feb 25). *4 Types Of Creativity*. Retrieved from Marketing91: <https://www.marketing91.com/4-types-of-creativity/>

Sicinski, A. (2019, March 19). *HOW TO THINK MORE CREATIVELY*. Retrieved from IQ Doodle : <https://iqdoodle.com/think-creatively/>
